

Day 63 阅读的意义

绒花儿 NegentropyLearning 2026年1月5日 19:09 四川

Franklin
Benjamin

Read **B**ook **o** **k** **s** ing



Fun Facts About BF

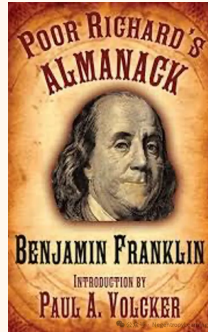
1. Ben, the educator/philanthropist–Uni of Pennsylvania



Laws without morals are useless.
Leges sine moribus vanae.
法无德不立。

賓夕法尼亞大學
University of Pennsylvania

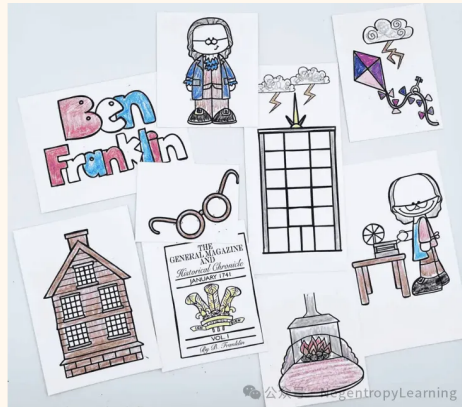
2. Ben, the writer



3. Ben, the politician—Signer of 4 founding documents



4. Ben, the inventor



5. Ben, as the embodiment of 'American Dream'

PART ONE

paragraph 1-2



1. *From a child I **was** fond of reading, and all the little money [that **came** into my hands] **was** ever laid out in books.*

Words

1) be fond of:

to like someone or something very much, often with warm, affectionate feelings.

[SYN]: be keen on; be partial to; have a liking for; be attached to

2) lay out [v.]:

to spend a large/significant amount of money on something.
花（或支付）一大笔钱，常指一次性或为了某个特定目的支付

⚠ lay [vt]: lay-laid-laid-laying

👉 放/搁/下蛋

lie [vi]: lie-lay-lain-lying

👉 躺/位于

lie [vi]: lie-lied-lied-lying

👉 撒谎

Paraphrasing & Translation

I loved reading from a child, so I spent whatever little money I could get in buying books.

我自幼喜欢读书，手头所有的零钱全用来买书了。

2. *Pleased with the The Pilgrim's Progress, my first collection **was** of John Bunyan's works in separate little volumes.*

Words

1) Pilgrim [n.]:

a person who travels to a holy place for religious reasons;
one of the English settlers who traveled to North America in 1620
on the Mayflower
朝圣者；清教徒

2) volume [n.]:

a book that is part of a series; one of several related books

其他意思：

a. 音量

e.g. For war news he turned up the volume on the television.
[para.2]

e.g. Crank up the volume.

b. 体积/容量

c. 规模

d. 头发蓬松度

Paraphrasing & Translation

I was delighted with *The Pilgrim's Progress*, and my first collection consisted of John Bunyan's works, each in its own small series.

我那时喜欢读《天路历程》，于是我收藏的第一批书便是约翰·班扬的分册文集。

2026

Background ✨

John Bunyan & *The Pilgrim's Progress*

John Bunyan (1628–1688) was a 17th-century English Nonconformist preacher and writer, best known for *The Pilgrim's Progress* (Part I, 1678; Part II, 1684), a Christian allegory in which a traveller's journey to the "Celestial City" represents a believer's struggle through sin, temptation, and doubt toward salvation. Bunyan's preaching outside the Church of England led to long periods of imprisonment, and this experience deeply shaped the plain, urgent style and spiritual themes of his writing; besides *The Pilgrim's Progress*, he also wrote *Grace Abounding* (a spiritual autobiography) and *The Holy War*, and his work became one of the most influential classics of English religious literature.

约翰·班扬（John Bunyan, 1628–1688）是英国17世纪的清教徒/非国教派布道者与作家，最著名的作品是宗教寓言小说《天路历程》（*The Pilgrim's Progress*，第一部1678、第二部1684），用“朝圣者”的旅程象征基督徒从罪与试探中挣扎、走向“天城”的信仰之路；他因未获许可讲道而多次遭到迫害并长期入狱，这段经历也深刻影响了他的写作风格与主题，除《天路历程》外还写有自传式信仰告白《恩典丰沛》（*Grace Abounding*）和寓言《圣战》（*The Holy War*），对英语宗教文学与寓言传统影响很大。



3. *I afterward **sold** them to enable me to buy R. Burton's Historical Collections; they **were** small chapmen's books, and cheap, 40 or 50 in all.*

1) enable [v.]:

to make something possible or provide the means to do something

使.....能够 / 让.....成为可能

2) chapman [n.]:

Historical Meaning——A Merchant or Peddler (Archaic Use)
(古义/英式) 小贩; 行商; 货郎



George Chapman

他以英译《荷马史诗》(常被称作 Chapman's Homer) 很出名, 所以在文学评论里看到 Chapman, 经常就是指他。

Paraphrasing & Translation

I later sold them in order to purchase R. Burton's Historical Collections; they were small inexpensive chapbooks sold by peddlers, around 40 or 50 in total.

后来我把它卖了, 用这笔钱买了 R.伯顿的《历史文集》。这部文集开本很小, 由商贩售卖, 价格不贵, 共有四五十本。

2026

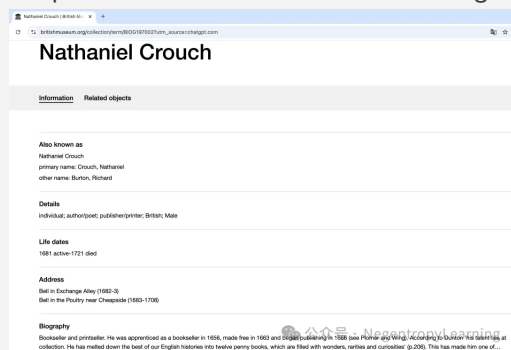
Background ✨

R. Burton

Nathaniel Crouch (约1632—约1725) 的常用化名(笔名); 他是伦敦的出版人/通俗读物编纂者, 写了很多便宜的小册子(chapbooks), 经常用 R. Burton / Richard Burton / Robert Burton 等名号出版。

来源: British Museum 等资料把 Richard Burton 作为他的别名之一。

<https://www.britishmuseum.org/collection/term/BIOG197002?utm>



4. *My father's little library **consisted** chiefly **of** books in **polemic divinity**, [most of which I **read**,] and (I) **have** since often **regretted** [that, at a time [when I **had** such a thirst for knowledge], more proper books **had not fallen** in my way [since it **was** now **resolved** (that) [I **should not** be a **clergyman**]]].*

My father's little library **consisted** chiefly of books in polemic divinity,

→ most of which I **read**,

→ and (I) **have** since often **regretted** that ...

→ at a time when I **had** such a thirst for knowledge,

→ more proper books **had not fallen** in my way,

→ since it **was resolved** that I **should not** be a clergyman.

Words

1) A consist of B [v.]:

it is used to describe the elements or components that form a whole; the subject of the sentence with "consist of" is typically the whole entity, and it "consists of" parts.

⚠ 无被动用法

[SYN] A be made up of B; A be composed of B;

由.....组成 / 由.....构成 (强调“整体=这些部分”)

💡 consist in = “在于”（本质/关键点）
Happiness consists in being content.
幸福在于知足。

2) polemic [n./adj.]:

a strong, often controversial or aggressive written or verbal attack on a particular opinion, belief, or ideology.
（言辞/文章）带攻击性、为反驳对手而写的“论战式/辩难式”

"Bookstores in the US," he wrote, "are filled with shabby screeds [n. 长篇大论; 冗长的文章] bearing screaming headlines about Islam and terror, Islam exposed, the Arab threat and the Muslim menace, all of them written by political polemists [n. 善辩者; 善于辩论的人; 有辩才的人—Polemics] pretending to knowledge imparted by experts [who have supposedly penetrated to the heart of these strange oriental people...]" 公众号: NegentropyLearning

3) divinity [n.]:

the state or quality of being divine, or related to a god or deity.
神性/神格（具有神的性质、神圣属性）；在这里更像“神学”

4) have a thirst for doing:

it means to have a strong desire or eagerness for something, especially for knowledge or learning.
对……有强烈渴望/求知欲/热情
[SYN] be hungry for; crave to do; have a passion for; be enthusiastic about; have an intense appetite for; have a hankering for; be desirous of

5) resolve [v.]:

💡 to find a solution to a problem or difficulty.
解决（问题/矛盾/困难）
💡 to make a firm decision to do something
下定决心；决意
💡 (formal) to decide officially, especially by a group.
（正式）决议；决定；表决通过。
It was resolved=it was decided...

6) should

Mandative should
要求式/决议式（mandative）结构

•形式上：像“虚拟语气”（因为不用真实时态，而用 should + 动词原

形)。

•意义上：不是“与事实相反的假设”，而是“规定/决定的内容”。

结构：用于表达命令、建议、要求、决定等“权威性内容”的 that 从句。

触发词：

•insist / demand / suggest / recommend / propose / request / order/decide / resolve

以及：It is necessary/important/essential that...



英美差异：英式常用 should, 美式常用“原形虚拟”

7) clergyman [n.]

a male member of the clergy, especially a Christian minister/priest

(基督教) 神职人员；牧师；教士（通常指男性；复数 clergymen）

Paraphrasing & Translation

My father had a collection of books which made a little library. The books were mainly about religion/theology. I read most of them and always felt regretful because rather than those religious books I should have read more proper books at the time when I was longing for knowledge. Especially when I did decide not to become a clergyman, those books provided me less value.

我父亲有一个小藏书室，里面主要是一些关于神学论辩的书籍。这些书我大多都读过。但令我时常感到遗憾的是，当时求知若渴的我没能读到更合适的书，因为当时我已经下定决心不做牧师了。

5. Plutarch's (Parallel) Lives there **was** in which **I read abundantly**, and I still **think** that time spent to great advantage.

1) abundantly [adv.]:

it refers to something occurring in great quantity, often with an emphasis on plentifulness or excess

大量地、广泛地

2) to great advantage:

it means doing something in a way that provides significant benefit, success, or improvement.

大有裨益/有效/划算/值得

⚠ 本句一个特色是“倒装”

正常语序为: There was Plutarch's (*Parallel*) *Lives*...

Paraphrasing & Translation

I read Plutarch's *Parallel Lives* extensively, and I still consider that time well spent.

(普鲁塔克的) 《名人传》倒是有, 我也曾一读再读, 而且我至今仍觉得读那本书的时光非常有意义。

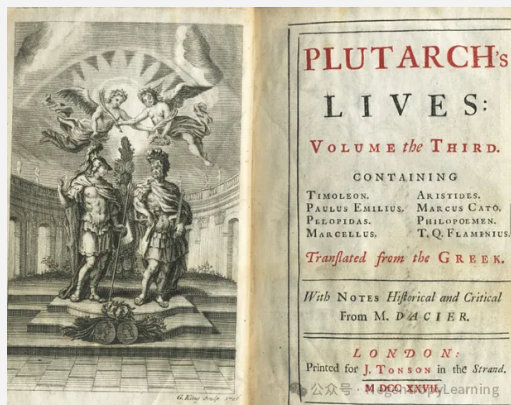
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Background ✨

Plutarch's (Parallel) Lives

Plutarch, Ancient Greek, was a Greek Middle Platonist philosopher, historian, biographer, essayist, and priest at the Temple of Apollo in Delphi.

Parallel Lives 是一组人物传记，把一位希腊人物和一位罗马人物成对比较（“parallel”= 对照/并列），通过生平与品格对比来讲道德与政治经验。



6. There **was** also a book of Defoe's, called *An Essay on Projects*, and another of Dr. Mather's, called *Essays to Do Good*, which perhaps **gave** me a turn of thinking that **had** an influence on some of the principal future events of my life.

1) a turn of thinking [n.]:

a shift or change in the way a person is thinking or approaching a problem, situation, or idea.

思路/观点的转变；看法一转

2) have an influence on:

to have an effect or impact on something or someone, causing a change in behavior, thought, or condition

对.....有影响；影响到.....；左右

[SYN] play a role in; exert an impact on; make an impact on; shape the outcome of; affect the course of; leave a mark on

3) principal [adj.]:

describing something that is the most important or main element in a situation or structure.

重大的

Paraphrasing & Translation

There was also a book by Defoe titled *An Essay on Projects*, and another by Dr. Mather called *Essays to Do Good*, which may have shaped my thinking in a way that influenced some of the key events in my future.

当时还有笛福的《论计划》和马瑟博士的《论行善》，这两本书让我转变了思想，甚至对我未来生活的一些重大事件产生了影响。

2026

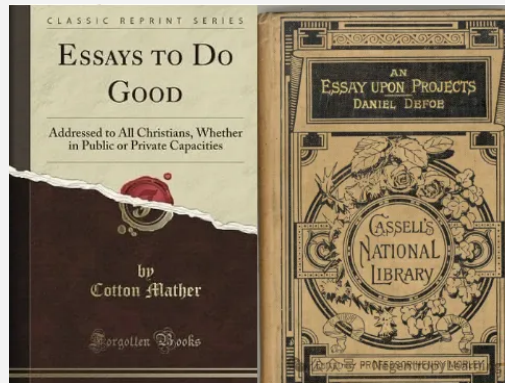
Background ✨

Daniel Defoe

He was an English novelist, journalist, merchant, pamphleteer and spy. He is most famous for his novel *Robinson Crusoe*, published in 1719, which is claimed to be second only to the Bible in its number of translations

Dr. Mather(Cotton Mather)

He was a prominent American Puritan minister, theologian, and author in the late 17th and early 18th centuries.



7. *This bookish inclination at length **determined** my father to make me a printer, though he **had** already one son (James) of that profession.*

1) bookish [adj.]:

it suggests a quality or characteristic of being very focused on reading, studying, or learning from books, often with a connotation of being somewhat academic or theoretical rather than practical or experiential.-----Bookworm

书卷气的；好读书的；（有时）书呆子气的

2) inclination [n.]:

it refers to a tendency, preference, or a natural disposition toward something.

倾向；爱好；意向

3) at length :

for a long period of time; eventually / finally

最终/终于

4) determine sb. to do:

caused / led / prompted sb. to decide to do... (an older, more formal pattern)

促使/使得某人下决心去做

5) profession [n.] :

it refers to a type of job or career that requires specialized education, training, and skills.

（通常指需资格/专门训练的）职业；专业

Paraphrasing & Translation

This love for books eventually led my father to decide to make me a printer, even though he already had one son, James, in that career.

因为我对书的迷恋，我父亲最终决定让我做一名印刷工人，虽然当时他还有一个儿子（詹姆斯）也从事这一职业。

8. *In 1717 my brother James **returned** from England with a press and letters to set up his business in Boston.*

W
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1) press [n.]:

a machine used for printing text or images, typically onto paper. It is an important invention in the history of mass communication.

印刷机

2) letters [n.]:

It refers to official documents or letters of authorization—essentially a form of permission or formal approval, often granted by an authority. These letters were likely given to James by English authorities to establish his printing press business in Boston.

铅字

("Letters" would also be the metal or wooden typesets (such as movable type) that James brought back with him from England. These would be used in the press to print text.)

官方文件

3) set up [v]:

To create, establish, or organize something, such as a business, system, or event.

开办

Paraphrasing & Translation

In 1717, my brother James came back from England with a printing press and movable types/documents to establish his business in Boston.

1717年，我的哥哥詹姆斯从英国回来，带回来一台印刷机和一套铅字/相关证书，他在波士顿创立了自己的印刷厂。

9. *I **liked** it much better than that of my father, but*

still **had** a hankering for the sea.

W
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1) hankering [n.]:

a strong desire or craving, especially for something that is difficult or impossible to obtain.

渴望

Paraphrasing & Translation

I preferred it far more than my father's way of life, but I still had a strong longing for the sea.

比起我父亲的工作，我更喜欢这个职业，尽管如此，我仍然向往航海。

10. To prevent the apprehended effect of such an inclination, my father **was** impatient to have me bound to my brother.



1) apprehend [v.]:

to catch and arrest someone who has not obeyed the law
(尤指警方) 抓住并逮捕某人

to take hold of mentally; perceive; understand
理解; 领会; 觉察到 (较正式/文学)

to anticipate especially with anxiety, dread, or fear
担心; 忧惧; 预感 (较少用/偏正式)

2) the apprehended effect = the feared / anticipated (bad) effect

担心会出现的后果 / 预感到的不良影响

3) be impatient to:

it expresses a feeling of eagerness or an urgent desire to do something.

急于/迫不及待要做某事 (强调“很想尽快发生”, 不等了)

4) have sth done

arrange for something to be done to the object
主语安排/促成“宾语被做某事” (通常不是主语亲自去做)
(使役/委托: 让某事被完成)

4) bind sb (to do sth) ≈ sb be bound (to do sth)

they express the same obligation, but from different viewpoints—
active focuses on the binder;

(合同/法律/承诺等) 把某人约束到必须做某事 (主动: 强调“约束者”在起作用)

passive focuses on the person obligated.

某人受约束/有义务必须做某事 (被动: 强调“被约束的人”处于义务状态)



be bound to do 还有一个常见义项是“肯定会... (strongly likely)”, 那种情况下就不等于 bind 的被动。

Paraphrasing & Translation

To avoid the bad outcome he feared from my desire to go to sea, my father was eager to bind me as an apprentice to my brother.

为了避免我这种想出海的念头可能带来的（他所担心的）后果，我父亲急着把我按学徒契约送去跟我哥哥学手艺。

11. I **stood out** some time, but at last **was persuaded**, and **signed** the indentures when I **was yet but** twelve years old.

Words



1) stand out [v.]:

this use of "stand out" conveys the idea of delaying or opposing something before ultimately yielding. It's different from the typical "stand out" (as in "be noticeable"), focusing here on the act of holding one's ground before agreeing or being persuaded.
顶住不答应/坚持不同意一阵子

2) persuade [v.]:

To convince someone to do or believe something through reasoning, argument, or appeal.
说服

3) indenture [n]:

a formal legal agreement/contract, especially an apprenticeship contract
学徒契约/契据（正式文件）

4) yet but:

only / merely
仅仅、才

这里 yet 不是“然而”；更像“still / as yet”，而 but 是“only”。两个叠加，语气更强调“年纪太小”

Paraphrasing & Translation

I resisted for a while, but in the end I was convinced and signed the apprenticeship contract when I was only twelve.

我起初坚持不答应了一阵子，但最后还是被说服了，在我才十二岁的时候就签了学徒契约。

12. *I **was** to serve as an apprentice till I **was** twenty-one years of age, only I **was** to be allowed journeyman's wages during the last year.*

Words



1) apprentice [n.]:

a person who is learning a trade or craft through hands-on experience under the supervision of a skilled worker or master.

学徒

2) only [conj.]:

only (conjunction) = except that / but

不过/只是（有一个例外/限制条件）

⚠ 不常见

3) journeyman [n.]:

a skilled worker who has completed an apprenticeship and is fully qualified to work in a trade or craft but is not yet a master.

出师工匠/熟练工

Paraphrasing & Translation

According to the terms, I was to serve as an apprentice to my brother until I turned twenty-one, and I was only to receive journeyman's wages during the final year.

根据契约，我当学徒必须干到二十一岁，只有最后一年允许领熟练工工资 / 出师工工资。

13. *In a little time I **made** great proficiency in the business, and **became** a useful hand to my brother.*

Words



1) proficiency [n.]:

the state of being skilled, competent, or highly capable in a particular area or activity. It refers to a high level of ability or expertise gained through practice, experience, or education

熟练；精通；熟练程度；（能力上的）进步

2) a useful hand [n.]:

It refers to someone who is helpful, capable, and contributes positively to a task or situation.

得力帮手；好用的人手；能干的雇工/助手

💡 synecdoche 提喻: hand（身体部位“手”）代指 worker/person（“人手/劳动力”），属 part-for-whole.

Paraphrasing & Translation

In a short period, I made significant progress in the trade and became a valuable helper to my brother.

不久我就熟练起来，成为了我哥哥的得力助手

14. I now **had** access to better books.

W
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s

1) have access to:

to have the opportunity or right to use, see, or enter something
有权/有机会使用、接触、进入（某物/某处）；可以获得（信息/资源）

Paraphrasing & Translation

I was now able to obtain better books.

这时我也能够接触到更好的书籍了。

15. An acquaintance with the apprentices of
booksellers **enabled** me sometimes to borrow a small one,
which I **was** careful to return soon and clean.

W
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s

1) acquaintance [n.]:

a person one knows slightly or casually but who is not a close friend. An acquaintance can be someone you casually meet in various social settings, such as a colleague, neighbor, or someone you know from a class.

熟人；相识的人；泛泛之交（非密友）

knowledge gained by experience; knowledge of something （通过接触/经验获得的）了解；熟悉；相熟关系

e.g.

have some acquaintance with sth 对.....略有了解/熟悉

Paraphrasing & Translation

Knowing some booksellers' apprentices sometimes allowed me to borrow a small book, and I took care to return it quickly and in clean condition.

由于认识了几个书商的学徒，我有时候就能借到一本小书，我看书非常在意/小心，很快就能干干净净地归还。

16. *Often I **sat** up in my room reading the greatest part of the night, when the book **was** borrowed in the evening and (was) to be returned early in the morning, lest it **should be** missed or wanted.*

Words

1) be to do:

it is used (mainly in formal English) to talk about plans/arrangements/official decisions/instructions.

(较正式) 按安排/决定“将要/应当”做某事 (常见于通知、会议决定、契约条款、新闻报道)

it can refer to what someone is obliged/required to do (formal)
有义务/被要求必须 (契约/规则语气很强)

2) lest [conj.]

in order to prevent any possibility that something will happen;
for fear that (formal/literary).

以免；唯恐；生怕 (非常正式/文学/旧文体常见)

句法功能上是为了引导 (否定) 目的从句

Paraphrasing & Translation

I often stayed up in my room reading for most of the night, especially when the book was borrowed in the evening and had to be returned early in the morning, so it wouldn't be noticed missing or in need.

如果书是晚上借来而一早就得还回去时，我会经常坐在我房间里读至夜深，以免别人发现书不见了，或第二天有人正要用（找）那本书。



PART ONE

paragraph 1-2

1. *And after some time an ingenious tradesman, Mr. Matthew Adams, who **had** a pretty collection of books, and who **frequented** our printing-house, **took notice** of me, **invited** me to his library, and very kindly **lent** me such books as I **chose** to read.*

1) ingenious [adj.]:

describing someone or something that is clever, creative, or resourceful, especially in a way that shows originality or inventiveness

聪明有创意的；心灵手巧、点子多的；有巧思的（偏“会想办法/有新意”，不只是“聪明”）

2) pretty [adj.]:

fairly/quite good-sized or impressive
相当不错的一批 / 挺可观的一套（藏书）

3) frequent [v]:

it means to visit or go to a place regularly or often.
经常去（某地）；常在某处出入

4) take notice of sb.

To pay attention to or become aware of someone

5) as

在这里是关系代词，引导定语从句

E.g.

He gave me such help as I needed.

Take such measures as are necessary.

Paraphrasing & Translation

And soon after, an intelligent businessman named Matthew Adams often came to our printing-house and paid attention to me. He had kept many books in his library, and very kindly invited me there and lent me the books that I chose to read.

不久之后，一位名叫马修·亚当斯的聪明商人，由于经常光顾我们印刷厂，注意到了我。此人藏书颇丰，他邀请我去参观他的图书室，还非常友好地借给了我一些我想要看的书。

2. I now **took** a fancy to poetry, and **made** some little pieces; my brother, thinking it **might turn** to account, **encouraged** me, and **put** me on composing occasional ballads.

W
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1) take a fancy to sth.:

to develop a liking or attraction for something or someone, often in an immediate or somewhat whimsical way.

突然喜欢上/对.....产生兴趣；看上、中意（语气偏口语、带点“兴致来得快”）

2) turn to account :

to make use of or exploit something for a specific purpose or benefit.

加以利用；变成对自己有利/有用（甚至能带来收益）的东西（偏书面/旧式）

3) put sb. on doing:

it generally means to assign or direct someone to do a particular task or activity

让/促使/鼓励某人去做某事（给任务/引导去做）

4) occasional [adj.]

of, for, or created for a particular occasion

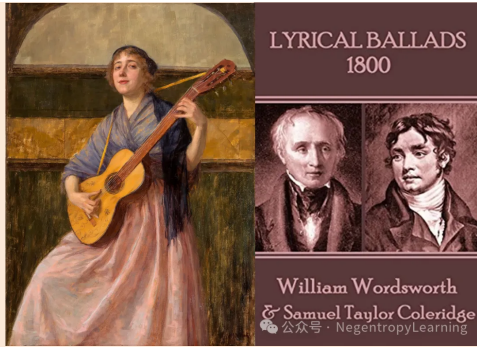
为特定场合/事件而作的；应景的

⚠ 也可以表示偶尔发生的；不规律的

5) ballad [n.]:

it is a type of narrative poem or song that typically tells a story, often one of love, tragedy, or historical events.

叙事歌谣；民谣式故事诗（常可唱）



Paraphrasing & Translation

I developed an interest in poetry and wrote a few small pieces. My brother, believing it could be useful, encouraged me and suggested I start composing occasional narrative poems.

我那时开始喜欢上诗歌，也写了几首小作品；我哥哥觉得这可能能派上用场，就鼓励我，还让我去写一些应景的叙事歌谣。

3. *One **was called** The Lighthouse Tragedy, and **contained** an account of the drowning of Captain Worthilake, with his two daughters; the other **was** a sailor's song, on the taking of Teach (or Blackbeard) the pirate.*

1) contain [v.]:

To hold something within or include it as a part of a whole.
包含；载有；收录 (= include)

2) account [n.]:

a report or description of an event, situation, or experience.
记述；叙述；报道；描述（偏“讲述一件事的经过”）

3) taking [n.]:

the capture (of a person), especially by force or authority.
抓获；擒获；捕获；拿获（旧文体/新闻叙事里常见）

4) pirate [n.]:

it is a person who engages in acts of robbery, violence, or hijacking on the high seas or in other navigable waters.

Paraphrasing & Translation

One was titled *The Lighthouse Tragedy*, which narrated the drowning of Captain Worthilake and his two daughters. The other was a sailor's song about the capture of Teach (or Blackbeard), the pirate.

其中一首叫《灯塔悲剧》，写的是沃思莱克船长和他的两个女儿溺水的事，此外还有一首是水手之歌，内容是关于捉拿海盗提奇（外号“黑胡子”）的事。

2026

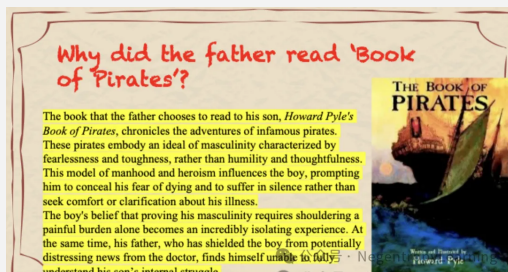
Background ✨

The Taking of Teach

The Taking of Teach the Pirate was written upon hearing of the news of the killing of Edward Teach, also known as Blackbeard the Pirate, who had been stealing from shipping vessels and coastal towns along the east coast of North America and the East Indies for several years. The poem recounts the last hours of Blackbeard's life as he fought against Lieutenant Robert Maynard and his sailors. On the morning of November 22, 1718, Blackbeard was dead, his severed head proudly displayed, as Lieutenant Maynard sailed home to claim the prize for killing such a despised soul.

The Lighthouse Tragedy

The Lighthouse Tragedy was inspired by the drowning on November 3, 1718, of George Worthylake, keeper of the light on Beacon Island, with his wife and daughter. (In the autobiography he remembered it incorrectly as Worthilake and his two daughters.) On their way back from a party, they boarded a sloop[单桅帆船]. The sloop anchored near Little Brewster Island, and a slave paddled out in a canoe to transfer them to the island, but the canoe—possibly overloaded—capsized[倾覆], and all people drowned.



4. They **were** wretched stuff, in the Grub-street-ballad style; and when they **were** printed he **sent** me about the town to sell them.

1) wretched [adj.]:

It can also describe something that is of very low quality or disappointing; =trashy

拙劣的；糟糕透的；差劲的（这里指作品质量）

2) Grub-street:

Grub Street originally referred to a street in London that became associated with impoverished writers and hacks in the 17th and 18th centuries. Over time, the term "Grub Street" evolved to describe low-quality or poorly paid writing, often produced by writers who were desperate for work or motivated by financial necessity rather than literary merit.

“格拉布街”文风：指粗制滥造、迎合市场、缺少文学价值的廉价写作（常带贬义）。

3) set sb. about sp. :

It generally means to assign or direct someone to go to a particular place to carry out a specific task or activity

打发/派某人到处跑（满城转）去做某事

Paraphrasing & Translation

They were dreadful pieces, in the style of ballads of lower quality; and once they were printed, he asked me to go to the town to sell them.

这些东西写得很拙劣，就是那种“格拉布街”廉价歌谣的路数；等一印出来，他就打发我满城去兜售。

5. *The first **bold** wonderfully, the event being recent, having made a great noise.*

1) recent [adj.]:

refer to something that has happened, been done, or appeared not long ago

最近的；新近发生的

2) make a noise:

it can also refer to making a big fuss or attracting attention in a noticeable way.

引起轰动；闹得沸沸扬扬；引发大量议论

Paraphrasing & Translation

The first one sold amazingly well, as the event newly happened and had attracted a lot of attention.

第一首诗卖的很好，因为写的是最近发生并引起轰动的事。

6. *This **flattered** my **vanity**; but my father **discouraged** me by **ridiculing** my performances, and telling me **verse-makers** **were** generally **beggars**.*

1) flatter [v.]:

to praise someone in order to please them (often excessively or insincerely)

奉承；讨好；（过分）恭维

2) vanity [n.]:

too much pride in your appearance or achievements

虚荣心；自负（对外表或成就的过度在意）

E.g.

Fine. But vanity wasn't my ruling passion then. (from *I Became a Student*)

3) ridicule [v]:

to ridicule means to mock, make fun of, or laugh at someone or something in a way that expresses contempt or disrespect.

嘲笑；奚落；讥讽（带贬低）

4) verse-makers [n]:

a verse-maker refers to someone who creates or composes poetry or verses

写打油诗的人；写诗匠（常带轻视/贬义，不如“poet”体面）



Ballad is typically a narrative poem or song (often meant to be sung), while verse is a broader term that can mean a line of poetry, a stanza, or poetry in general, whether narrative or not.



5) beggar [n.]

a beggar is someone who solicits charity from others, often due to poverty or extreme need. Begging typically involves asking passersby for help, either in the form of money, food, or shelter.

乞丐；靠施舍过活的人

Paraphrasing & Translation

This boosted my ego, but my father dampened my enthusiasm by mocking my work and telling me that poets were usually pathetic.

这让我的虚荣心得到了极大满足。但我父亲却不以为然，他拿我的诗取笑我，并说写诗之人大多是可怜乞丐。

7. So I escaped being a poet, most probably a very bad one; but

as prose writing **had been** of great use to me in the course of my life, and **was** a principal means of my advancement, I **shall tell** you how, in such a situation, I **acquired** what little ability I **have** in that way.

W
o
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1) escape doing :

avoid doing something / manage not to do something (often by luck or by avoiding an outcome)

躲过/免于 (做某事或落入某种处境)

2) be of great use:

be very helpful / very useful (to someone) 对.....非常有用; 帮了大忙

3) course [n]:

during; over a period of time / while something is happening

在.....过程中; 在.....期间; 纵观.....这一段时间

[SYN]

E.g.

In the cycle of my life in Max Apple's *Roommates*; (Journey)

4) advancement [n.]:

It refers to the act of improving, growing, or making progress in some area of life, such as in a career, skills, or knowledge.

晋升; 上进; 发展; (地位/事业) 提升

5) acquire [v.]:

to gain/obtain something, especially a skill/ability/knowledge

获得; 习得 (技能/能力/知识)



Obtain: Focuses on the immediate or direct act of getting something, usually physical items or specific outcomes.

Acquire: Implies a gradual or long-term process of gaining something, often used for skills, knowledge, or valuable assets.

获得; 习得 (技能/能力/知识)

Paraphrasing & Translation

Thus, I avoided becoming a poet and it was most likely I would be a very poor one; however, since prose writing had been extremely helpful to me throughout my life and was a key factor in my success, I will share how, in such circumstances, I developed whatever modest skill I possess in that area.

所以我总算没有当上诗人——很可能还会是个很差的诗人；但由于散文写作在我一生中对我帮助极大，并且是我获得进步与提升的重要途径之一，我就来告诉你：在那样的处境下，我是怎样习得我这点写作能力的。



PART TWO paragraph 3-4-5



1. There **was** another bookish lad in the town, John Collins by name, with whom I **was** intimately acquainted.

1) lad [n.]:

It is often used informally to refer to a young boy or a male teenager, sometimes in a friendly or affectionate way.

小伙子；男孩；少年（口语/亲切）

2) by name:

It refers to identifying or mentioning someone or something specifically by their name rather than by description, title, or role.

名叫.....；叫作.....

3) be acquainted with:

it means to be familiar with or have knowledge of someone or something.

认识；相识；熟悉（某人）

Paraphrasing & Translation

There was another bookish boy in town, named John Collins, with whom I knew well.

镇上还有一位爱读书的小伙，名叫约翰·柯林斯，我们走得很近

2. *We sometimes disputed, and very fond we were of argument, and (were) very desirous of confuting one another, [which disputatious turn, by the way, is apt to become a very bad habit, making people often extremely disagreeable in company by the contradiction [that is necessary to bring it into practice]; and thence, besides souring and spoiling the conversation, is productive of disgusts and, perhaps enmities [where you may have occasion for friendship].]*

We sometimes **disputed**,
→ and very fond we **were** of argument,
→ and (were) very desirous of confuting one another,
→ [which disputatious turn, by the way, is apt to become a very bad habit,
→ ... by the contradiction [that is necessary ...];
→ ... is productive of ... [where you may **have** occasion for friendship].
]

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1) dispute [v.]:

To dispute means to argue, challenge, or deny the truth or validity of something

争辩；争论；辩论

2) be fond of:

Inversion—— "Very fond we were" is a stylistic inversion of "we were very fond" to emphasize the strong liking for argument.

（为强调/文体把表语提前）。

3) be desirous of:

it means to want or long for something

渴望；很想（做某事）（较正式）

4) confute [v.]

to prove that someone or something is wrong by argument or evidence; refute

驳倒；驳斥；证伪（用论据证明对方错）

5) disputatious [adj.]:

inclined to argue; fond of disputing (often in an annoying way).

好争辩的；爱抬杠的；争论癖的（偏贬）

6) be apt to

likely to; tends to (do sth), especially as a usual tendency.

容易……；往往会……；有……倾向

7) disagreeable

unpleasant; hard to like; irritating

讨人嫌的；令人不快的；让人不舒服的

[ANT] congenial

E.g.

It was clear to both of us that in spite of a 60-year age gap I was his most congenial companion. (from *My Roommate*)

8) in company

in social situations; when you are with other people.

在他人面前；在社交场合；和别人一起时

9) contradiction

the act of contradicting; saying the opposite; constant opposing of others.

反驳；顶嘴式的否定；唱反调

10) thence

from that; as a result; hence/therefore (formal/older).

由此；因此；从那以后/从那件事起（偏旧/正式）

11) sour

to make (a mood/relationship) unpleasant or bitter.

使变坏；使变酸；使气氛变僵/变苦

12) spoil

to ruin; to destroy the enjoyment or quality of something.

破坏；毁掉（兴致/质量/氛围）

13) be productive of

to produce; to lead to; to result in (formal).

导致；产生；招致（正式）

14) disgust

strong dislike/aversion; feelings of being offended or repelled.

厌恶；反感；嫌恶感

15) enmity

hostility; hatred; a state of being enemies.

仇怨；敌意；结怨

16) have occasion for

to need; to have reason/opportunity to use something (formal).

需要；有必要；用得上

Paraphrasing & Translation

We sometimes argued, and we really loved debating. In fact, we were eager to refute each other. This argumentative tendency can easily become a bad habit: it makes people unpleasant to be around in social situations because putting it into practice requires constant contradiction. As a result, it not only sours and ruins conversations, but also breeds dislike—and sometimes even hostility—in situations where you might actually need friendship.

我们有时会争辩，而且我们都特别爱讲道理、爱抬杠，总想着把对方驳倒。顺便说一句，这种好争辩的性子很容易变成一种坏习惯：因为要把它“落实”出来就得不断唱反调，于是人在社交场合常常会变得很讨人嫌。由此除了把谈话气氛弄僵、把交流聊坏之外，它还会招来反感，甚至结下仇怨——而偏偏那些场合，你本来可能正需要友谊。

3. *I **had caught** it by reading my father's books of dispute about religion.*

W o r d s



1) catch a habit :

It means to develop or pick up a habit, typically in a natural or gradual way

染上/养成某个习惯（多指不太好的习惯）

Paraphrasing & Translation

I had picked it up from reading my father's books on religious debates.

我是在阅读我父亲关于宗教论辩的书籍时染上这种恶习的。

4. *Persons of good sense, I **have since observed**, seldom **fall into it**, except lawyers, university men, and men of all sorts that **have been bred** at Edinburgh.*

Words

1) person of good sense:

people who are sensible; who have good judgment/common sense.

有见识的人；明事理的人；判断力强的人

2) fall into a habit:

It means to unintentionally develop a habit or begin doing something regularly without consciously planning or trying to do so

不知不觉养成/陷入（某种习惯）

3) breed-bred-bred [v]:

The process of being raised, trained, or educated in a specific location or environment

“在某地受教育/被培养长大”（结果状态）。

[SYN] bring up



在Franklin 活动的伦敦文化圈里，拿苏格兰人开玩笑（包括“好争辩”之类）是常见现象

4) since

since (prep.) 介词：自从...以来

since 2020（自 2020 年以来）

since (conj.) 连词：自从/既然

since I met her... (自从我遇见她以来...)

Since you're here, ... (既然你来了,)

since (adv.) 副词：后来/从那以后

I moved to Shanghai and haven't been back since. (我搬去上海后就再也没回来过。)



Paraphrasing & Translation

I've since noticed that people of good sense rarely fall into this habit, except for lawyers, university-educated individuals, and people of various backgrounds who have been brought up in Edinburgh.

之后我观察发现，有识之士，除了律师、大学生以及在爱丁堡接受教育的各种人之外，很少会染上这种恶习。



PART TWO

paragraph 3-4-5

1. A question **was** once, somehow or other, **started** between Collins and me, of the propriety of educating the female sex in learning, and their abilities for study.

1) somehow or other

it is often used when the speaker doesn't want to focus on the details or when the method is either unknown or irrelevant
 不知怎么地；不管怎样；想方设法地（常带“细节不重要/说不清/懒得细说”）

2) propriety [n.]:

it is particularly associated with formal or traditional settings, where adhering to established social norms is valued/moral correctness
 恰当性；合宜性；是否妥当/得体



Good etiquette requires you to say “please” and “thank you,” but propriety also means being considerate in what you say and do, and respecting others' feelings and viewpoints.

Paraphrasing & Translation

Once for no reason/In an unspecified manner, Collins and I suddenly had a dispute over whether it's proper to educate women in learning and what study abilities women have.

有一次，不知为何，我与柯林斯因“女性是否应该受教育，以及她们是否有做学问的能力”这一问题起了争执。

2. *He was of opinion that it was improper, and that they were naturally unequal to it.*

1) be of opinion:

Someone holds a particular belief or point of view about something

某人认为/持这样的看法（较正式/旧式表达，≈ sb. thought/ believed）

2) be unequal to:

not capable of it / not up to it

没有能力胜任/天生不适合

Paraphrasing & Translation

He believed it was inappropriate and that women were naturally incapable of it.

柯林斯认为那样做不恰当，因为女性天生不是那块料。

3. *I **took** the contrary side, perhaps a little for dispute's sake.*

1) for sth./sb.'s sake:

it means that something is done in order to benefit, preserve, or protect a particular thing, person, or cause

(For the benefit/good/interest/welfare of)

为了.....的利益/缘故；看在.....份上；为.....着想

Paraphrasing & Translation

I took the opposing view, perhaps partly just for the sake of argument.

我与他持相反观点，但可能只是为了争辩而争辩。

4. *He **was** naturally more eloquent, **had** a ready plenty of words; and sometimes, as I **thought**, bore me down more by*

his fluency than by the strength of his reasons.

Words

1) eloquent [adj.]:

It refers to expressing ideas or emotions in a clear, persuasive, and effective manner

2) as i thought

as I thought 是 as 引导的插入性评注从句 (comment clause) , 在句中作“句子层面的状语/评注”, 不属于主干=in my opinion

3) bear down on sb./sth.

to move toward/attack with increasing force; to put strong pressure on; to overwhelm/overpower sb (less common in modern everyday speech, but very clear in older prose)

逼近; 猛压; 强力施压; 压制某人、使某人难以招架

! bear-bore-borne/born[后者多用于“出生”这个含义]

💡 plenty of words vs receive a word

receive word: to be informed; to get news (often formal/literary) 收到消息/通知; 得到口信 (常带“消息传来”的书面感)
hear (that...): 听说 (信息来源不一定正式)
be informed (that...): 被告知 (更正式)
get news / receive news: 得到消息 (中性)
learn (that...): 得知 (偏“后来才知道”)
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Paraphrasing & Translation

He was naturally more articulate, with an abundance of words at his disposal; and at times, I felt he overwhelmed me more with his fluency than with the strength of his arguments.

他天生比我能言善辩, 而且还善于用词。我觉得有时他之所以能够驳倒我, 不是因为他的论证多么有说服力, 而是因为他的论辩更加流利。

5. *As we **parted** without settling the point, and **were not to see one another again for some time**, I **sat down** to put my arguments in writing, which I **copied** fair and **sent** to him.*

6. He **answered**, and I **replied**.
7. Three or four letters of a side **had passed**, when my father **happened** to find my papers and read them.
8. Without entering into the discussion, he **took occasion to talk** to me about the manner of my writing; (he) **observed** that, [[though I **had** the advantage of my antagonist in correct spelling and pointing [(which I **owed** to the printing-house)]], [I **fell** far short in elegance of expression, in method and in perspicuity, [of which he **convinced** me by several instances.]]]

Without entering into the discussion, he **took** occasion to talk to me about the manner of my writing;

→ (he) **observed** that ...

→ though I **had** the advantage of my antagonist in correct spelling and pointing

→ (which I **owed** to the printing-house),

→ I **fell** far short in elegance of expression, in method and in perspicuity,
→ of which he **convinced** me by several instances.

1) take occasion to do:

To use an opportunity or seize a moment to do something
借机做某事/借机说起某事

2) have the advantage of:

to possess a benefit, superior position, or favourable condition
在某方面胜过/占优势

3) antagonist [n.]:

the opponent or adversary in a conflict
对手；论敌；辩论对方

4) pointing [n.]

punctuation (especially correct punctuation in writing/printing).

“标点符号的使用/标点法 (punctuation)” 的意思，属于较旧的法，尤其常见于印刷/写作语境里

5) owe to

to attribute something or give credit for something to a particular cause, source, or person
把.....归因于；归功于

6) fall short in

to express insufficiency or inadequacy in comparison to something
在.....方面不足/差得远

7) perspicuity [n.]

clarity or clearness in expression, thought, or presentation
表达清晰；明晰；条理清楚

Paraphrasing & Translation

My father didn't talk about the discussion between Collins and me; instead he took the chance to talk about the manner of my writing. He observed that I was better than Collins in correct word spelling and punctuation, which I know resulted from my work in the printing-house; and that I was worse than Collins in the choice of elegant expression, writing method and clarity. He used several examples from my writing to support his view and I completely agreed.

我俩分开之前，谁也没有说服谁，一时又见不上面，于是我坐在桌前将我的论辩付诸笔端，誊好后寄给他。他回信，我继续辩驳。一来二去，双方都写了三四封信后，我父亲碰巧翻看了我的信。他没有谈信中所讨论的问题，而是借此机会谈了谈我的文笔。据他发现，我在单词拼写、标点符号的准确性上均比对手略胜一筹（我把这种能力归功于我在印刷厂的工作经历），但是在措辞的优雅性、论述的条理性和表达的清晰性上却远不如对手。

9. I **saw** the justice of his remark, and thence **grew** more attentive to the manner in writing, and **determined** to endeavor at improvement.

1) grow attentive to

to gradually become more attentive/alert to something; to start paying close attention.

渐渐开始留心/注意到；对.....越来越关注

2) determine to do:

to decide firmly to do something; to resolve to do it.=be determined to do

下定决心做.....；决定做.....（语气更坚定）



determine sb to do (较旧) = cause/lead sb to do (促使某人做.....)

3) endeavor [v.]

To make a serious attempt or effort to do something

努力尝试；尽力；力求（较正式）

Paraphrasing & Translation

I recognized the validity of his comment, which made me more mindful of my writing style, and I decided to make an effort to improve.

他还一一举例，让我心服口服。我觉得他的评价非常中肯，自此我开始格外关注文笔，并决定在这方面多下功夫。



PART TWO

paragraph 3-4-5

1. *About this time I **met** with an odd volume of The Spectator.*

2. *It **was** the third.*
3. *I **had** never before **seen** any of them.*
4. *I **bought** it, **read** it over and over, and **was** much delighted with it.*
5. *I **thought** the writing excellent, and **wished**, if possible, to imitate it.*
6. *With this view I **took** some of the papers, and, making short hints of the sentiment in each sentence, **laid** them **by** a few days, and then, without looking at the book, **tried** to complete the papers again, by expressing each hinted sentiment [at length,] and [as fully as it **had been expressed** before], in any suitable words that **should come to hand**.*

With this view I **took** some of the papers,

→ and, making short hints of the sentiment in each sentence, **laid** them by a few days,

→ and then, without looking at the book, **tried** to complete the papers again,

→ by expressing each hinted sentiment [at length] and [as fully as it **had been expressed** before],

→ in any suitable words that **should come to hand**.  Negentropy Learning

1) sentiment [n.]:

A general opinion or view; the overall tone or attitude

每句话的意思/观点/情感倾向（这里 sentiment 更接近“句子要表达的意思/意旨”，不是单纯“情绪”）

2) lay by

把.....搁置/放一边（旧式表达）

3) at length

in detail or after a long period of time

详细地；充分展开地 | 终于；最终

4) come to hand

something has arrived or been received and is now available for use, attention, or action.

随手可得、信手拈来（脑子里/手边正好有）



at length 和 as fully as... 都是在修饰 expressing（表达/扩写）这一件事的方式/程度。

Paraphrasing & Translation

I decided to buy a copy (or a few volumes) of *The Spectator* and, after noting down the gist of each sentence, I set my notes aside for a few days. Then, without consulting the text, I used those outlines to reconstruct each sentence in any suitable words that came to mind, striving to match the original as closely as possible.

于是，我买下了一册《旁观者》，把每句话的主旨记下后搁置数日。随后不看原文，只凭那些提纲，用自己想到的合适措辞将句子完整地重写，力求贴近原文表达。



7. Then I **compared** my *Spectator* with the original, **discovered** some of my faults, and **corrected** them.
8. But I **found** (that) I **wanted** a stock of words, or a readiness in recollecting and using them, which I **thought** (that) I **shouldhave acquired** before that time if I **had gone** on making verses; since the continual occasion for words of the same import, but of different length, to suit the measure, or of different sound for the rhyme, **would have laid me under a constant necessity of searching for variety**, and also **have tended to** fix that variety in my mind, and (to) make me master

of it.

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→ and also **have tended** to fix that variety in my mind,

→ and (to) make me master of it.

公众号 · NegentropyLearning

W
o
r
d
s

1) readiness [n.]:

the state of being fully prepared or eager to do something
随时可用的状态 / 熟练度 / 反应速度”，更偏“准备充分、拿得出来”。

2) If Sb./Sth. had done, sb./sth. should have done

第三条件句——对过去的虚拟

3) import [n.]

it is used in a more formal sense to mean significance or meaning

尤指话语/行为/事件“所表达的意思/含义/重要性”)

4) measure [n.]

the rhythmic structure or pattern of a piece of writing, especially in poetry or music

诗行的格律/韵律/节奏模式

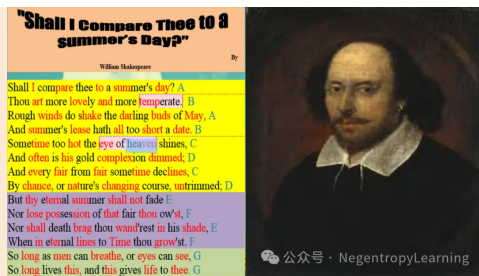
5) rhyme [n.]

the repetition of similar sounds, usually at the end of words, within a poem or song

尤其诗行末尾的押韵



same import / different length (measure) / different sound (rhyme)



6) tend to do [v.]

used to say that someone/something usually behaves in a particular

倾向/往往会

used to say that something is likely to happen as a result of a situation or action.

往往会导致/趋于产生某结果

7) lay sb. under the necessity of

to make it necessary for someone to do something; to force/compel someone to do something (formal)

使某人不得不…… / 使某人处于必须……的境地”（强调外部压力带来的必然要求）

Paraphrasing & Translation

But I realized I lacked a solid store of vocabulary—or the quickness to recall and use words when needed. I felt I should have built that up by then if I had kept writing verse. Poetry constantly calls for words with the same meaning but different lengths to fit the meter, or different sounds to make the rhyme. That would have forced me to keep searching for variety, and it would also have helped fix that variety in my mind and make me fully master it.

但我发现自己缺的，是一套够用的词汇储备，或者说，能迅速想起并灵活运用这些词的熟练度；我当时认为：要是我之前一直坚持写诗，到那时候这些能力本该已经练出来了。因为写诗时，你会不断需要用“意思相同、但长度不同”的词来适配诗的格律，或用“读音不同”的词来押韵——这就会让我长期处在一种不得不去寻找表达变化的状态；而这种反复搜寻，也会把这些变化牢牢固定在我脑子里，让我真正掌握它们。

9. *Therefore I **took** some of the tales and **turned** them into verse; and, after a time, when I **had** pretty well **forgotten** the prose, **turned** them back again.*

Paraphrasing & Translation

As a result, I took some of the stories and converted them into verse; and after a while, when I had almost completely forgotten the original prose, I turned them back into prose again.

因此，我选了几个故事，将其改写为诗歌。过了一段时间，当我完全忘记原文后，我再重新根据诗歌写出散文。

10. *I also sometimes **jumbled** my collections of hints into confusion, and after some weeks **endeavored** to reduce them into the best order, before I **began** to form the full sentences and complete the paper.*

W o r d s



1) jumble [v.]:

To mix things up in a disorderly or confusing way, causing them to be disorganized or in confusion.

把东西混在一起、弄乱、打散顺序，结果变得难以辨认/难以理清

2) endeavor to do

to try very hard to do something; to make a serious effort to achieve an aim. It's more formal than try to.

努力去做、力图做到

3) reduce A into B

To simplify, transform, or break something down into a more basic, smaller, or more manageable form

把 A 整理/归并/梳理成 B 的形式或状态

Paraphrasing & Translation

I also occasionally mixed up my collection of ideas into confusion, and after a few weeks, I tried to organize them in the best possible order before I began constructing full sentences and completing the paper. This was meant to teach me how to methodically arrange my thoughts.

这样做，我也偶尔把自己的想法收集弄得一团糟，几周后我尝试以最佳方式整理它们，然后开始构建完整的句子并完成文章。这是为了教我如何有条不紊地安排思路。

11. *This **was** to teach me method in the arrangement of thoughts.*
12. *By comparing my work afterward with the original, I **discovered** many faults and amended them; but I sometimes **had** the pleasure of fancying that, in certain particulars of small import, I **had been** lucky enough to improve the method or the language, and this **encouraged** me to think (that) I **might possibly** in time**come** to be a tolerable English writer, of which I **was** extremely ambitious.*

1) amend [v.]:

to change, alter, or correct something

修订/修改/改正（常用于正式文本：法律、条款、文件、文章稿件），强调“改动使其更好、更正确”

2) particulars

the particulars of something or someone are facts or details about them that are written down and kept as a record
细节/具体事项/具体之处（常见于说明、报告、登记信息等语境）

3) in time

eventually / sooner or later (after a period of time)

最终/迟早

not late / before a deadline (in time for sth)

及时/赶上

4) tolerable [adj]

acceptable, good enough, but not excellent; something you can
还行/过得去/勉强算可以（明显是“降调词”，表达谦虚、保守判断）

Paraphrasing & Translation

By comparing my work later with the original, I found many mistakes and corrected them; but sometimes, I took pleasure in imagining that, in certain minor details, I had been fortunate enough to improve the method or the language. This gave me hope that, with time, I might become a reasonably good English writer, a goal I was very eager to achieve.

通过把我后来写的文章和原文对照，我发现了许多问题并把它们改掉；但有时我也会暗自高兴地觉得：在某些无关紧要的小细节上，我竟然运气不错，把表达方式或措辞写得比原文还好一点。正是这种小小的“得意”，让我相信：也许随着时间推移，我最终能成为一个还算像样的英语写作者——而这正是我极其渴望实现的目标。

13. *My time for these exercises and for reading **was** at night, after*

work or before it **began** in the morning, or on Sundays, [when I **contrived** to be in the printing-house alone, [evading as much as I **could** the common attendance on public worship [which my father **used** to exact on me when I **was** under his care,]] and [which indeed I still **thought** a duty, [though I **could not**, [as it **seemed** to me], afford time to practice it.]]]

My time ... was

→ at night (after work / before work began)

→ or on Sundays when

I contrived to be alone,

evading attendance on public worship

which father used to exact on me (when under his care),

and which I still thought a duty,

though I couldn't (as it seemed to me) afford time to practice it.

Words

1) contrive to do

to manage or succeed in doing something, usually through cleverness, ingenuity, or effort

设法做到；想办法安排到（常暗示“费心/有点技巧/刻意安排”）

2) evade [v.]

to escape or avoid something

逃避；躲开；回避（责任/法律/问题/人）

3) worship [n]

deep religious respect and devotion

崇拜

4) exact [v.]

to demand and obtain something from someone, especially by force, authority, or pressure.

强行索取；逼迫要求（带“施压/强制”语气，偏正式/书面）

Paraphrasing & Translation

I dedicated my time to these exercises and reading at night, either after work or before it began in the morning, or on Sundays, when I managed to be alone in the printing house. I avoided, as much as possible, the usual obligation of attending public worship, which my father had required of me when I was under his care. Though I still considered it a duty, I felt I could not, as it seemed to me, afford the time to practice it.

我读书、练习写作都是在晚上下班后或者早上上班前，或者是在周日。一到周日，我总是想尽办法独自待在印刷厂，尽可能减少和父亲一起去教堂做例行礼拜，而以前由于父亲的管教，我不得不去。事实上，我现在仍认为去做礼拜是一种职责，只是我似乎抽不出时间罢了。



—END—